

7 Brutal Habits That Made Me Ripped & Rich EP 314

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter lays out 7 concrete habits for achieving fitness and financial goals, arguing that standards, accountability, friction management, and coaching matter far more than raw willpower or motivation.

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😂 Intro & "Midlife Crisis Content" Roast 2:06

- Brandon opens by describing a viral content genre he calls **"midlife crisis content"** — men in their late 30s+ acting like warriors or warlords online
 - Plays a clip of a guy telling his son never to call him "daddy" and instead use titles like "chief" or "warlord"
 - Brandon and his crew share these in a group chat for laughs
- Brandon's counterpoint: he called his dad "daddy" as a toddler and still grew up to be physically capable and financially successful
 - "I've brought myself out of the black ghetto to build several multi-million dollar businesses"
 - "I'm a great provider for my son, my family, the people I care about"
- Key point: being a strong man doesn't require performative toughness; real results speak for themselves

Sponsor Segments: Go High Level & Online Coaching 4:31

- **Sponsor 1: Go High Level** (CRM / customer management platform)
 - Brandon has used it for 6 years across all his businesses
 - Used for: email/SMS outreach, landing pages, sales pipelines, website hosting, scheduling social media posts
 - Free **30-day trial** available through the link in the description (vs. 1–2 weeks going direct)
 - Brandon plans to host free training sessions on how to use it for anyone who signs up through his link
- **Sponsor 2: Brandon's Online Coaching Program**
 - Taking on a limited number of 1-on-1 online coaching clients
 - How it works:
 - Client fills out application (first link in description)
 - Receives auto-generated text message within ~5 minutes via Go High Level
 - Must respond to that text — Brandon then personally follows up
 - Brandon creates a **custom diet plan** and **custom workout plan** for each client
 - Clients track food and workouts in a **custom app** — Brandon can see macros, calories, reps, sets in real time
 - Brandon checks in with every client **every single morning**
 - If they hit their goals: "Yo, good shit. Let's keep that momentum going."
 - If they missed: "What happened yesterday, bro? We need to get you back on track."
 - Core argument for coaching: "You can get a workout plan off ChatGPT. But you're not going to do it, bro, because you don't have accountability."

Market Update with Young Candlestick (Greg) 10:41

- **Overall market sentiment:** Seesaw / choppy — neutral on the Fear & Greed Index (previously at extreme fear)
 - Market has been flat for ~2 months; starting to look slightly bullish
 - VIX trade alert delivered a **100% gain overnight** for Victory Trades members
 - Key question: will the market break resistance to all-time highs or break down through support?
- **Individual stock highlights:**

Stock	Ticker	Thesis / Action
Arista Networks	ANET	All-time high breakout; members made \$700–\$76 overnight on call options
Oracle	ORCL	7–8% bounce overnight on call options
Qualcomm	QCOM	Day trade: \$80 turned into ~\$140–\$220 on morning session
Microsoft	MSFT	Bullish long-term; end-of-year target \$510 (~33% upside); earnings July 29

Stock	Ticker	Thesis / Action
Google	GOOGL	Broke out of trend line, back-tested; bullish long-term
Meta	META	Wild daily moves (dropped 7% in 2 days, then +9.5% same day); options order flow driven
Apple	AAPL	Bull flag breaking out near all-time highs; potential 300% gain on \$320 calls
Amazon	AMZN	Similar to Meta; bullish long-term target \$300–\$330/share
UNH (Healthcare)	UNH	Fresh breakout; +5% in a session; continuation expected
SpaceX	SPCX	Shorted; 31% gain; bearish below \$148
NBIS (AI Data Centers)	NBIS	Called at \$70, ran to \$300; now \$216; dip-buy target \$165

- **Apex Funded Account strategy:**

- Key insight: don't use the full leverage Apex provides (4NQ, 8NQ, 10NQ) — it's designed to blow accounts
- Correct approach: trade **1–3 MNQ contracts**, target **\$200–\$250/day**, max loss **\$100–\$200/day**
- Done consistently = **\$2,000–\$5,000/month payout**
- Greg made **\$4,500 in under 9 trading days** in July on one funded account
- **Theory:** No major market moves until after the FIFA World Cup ends — world attention is occupied
 - Strategy during this period: iron condors, bearish call credit spreads on weak stocks, bull put credit spreads on strong stocks
- **Japan (EWJ):** Up 15% year-to-date; similar pattern to US markets; watch YCS (yen ETF) — if it breaks out sharply, that's a potential black swan
- **Gold/Silver:** Dead sideways; possible falling wedge; GLD above \$400 could be a long
- **XLFF (Financials ETF):** Bounced off \$55 support; as long as \$55 holds, uptrend intact; financials are a major S&P weight

Super Chat: How to Launch an App with an Influencer 26:19

- Viewer (Robert, \$50 super chat): software engineer partnered with a popular niche influencer to build an app — needs the 80/20 on marketing resources
- Brandon's framework (based on the **"Launch" by Jeff Walker** playbook):
 - **Step 1 — Pre-Launch (start immediately):**
 - Have the influencer create content hyping the upcoming product on all platforms
 - "The longer the pre-launch, the more successful the launch"
 - Analogy: movies start promoting months before release, not the day they hit theaters
 - **Step 2 — Build an Email + SMS List NOW:**
 - Set up a landing page immediately — even before the product is ready

- Collect emails and phone numbers from the influencer's audience
- Start emailing/texting pre-launch content immediately after sign-up
- "You will leave a lot of money on the table" if you skip this
- Email drives **20–30% of revenue** for the average online company
- Tool: **Go High Level** — build landing pages, collect leads, send automated sequences
- **Step 3 — Ramp Up Content as Launch Approaches:**
 - Like movie trailers → then stars on the Tonight Show → hosting SNL → commercials everywhere
 - Go harder and faster as you get closer to launch date
- **Step 4 — Launch Day:**
 - Blast social media, email, and SMS simultaneously
 - Offer a **limited-time deal/incentive** for early sign-ups to create urgency
- **Key books recommended:**
 - *Launch* by Jeff Walker — best book on product launches (Brandon's copy is 10+ years old)
 - *Ready, Fire, Aim* — for post-launch growth strategy
- Greg's corroboration: used the launch system for his beginner course and made **\$30,000 on the first day**
- "Think of it like that. I hope that helped, brother."

🎯 Habit 1: Turn Goals Into Standards 50:28

- Core principle: **"You don't get what you want. You only get what you have to have."**
 - You won't rise to your ambitions — you'll fall to your standards
 - The fix isn't raising ambitions; it's raising standards
- Test for any goal you failed: was it a *must* or just a *good idea*?
 - If it was a must, you would have gotten it
- Analogy: a dope fiend spends ~\$100,000/year on their habit because it's a non-negotiable must
 - "Take the good, leave the bad" — match that *intensity*, not the criminal behavior
- Action steps:
 - Tonight, review all goals you set for this year (still 20+ weeks left)
 - Pick **one singular goal** — the dope fiend has one singular goal; you can't pursue 50 with that intensity
 - Reword the goal from a want to a refusal:
 - ❌ "I want to lose 20 pounds of fat"
 - ✅ "I refuse to lose anything less than 20 pounds of fat this year"
 - ❌ "I'm trying to make \$10,000 a month"
 - ✅ "I refuse for my income to be less than \$10,000 a month by the end of this year"

👁️ Habit 2: Keep Your Eyes on the Target (The List of Hate) 53:43

- Root cause of poor discipline: you stop thinking about what you want *most* and start thinking about what you want *now*
 - GPS analogy: if it loses its destination it goes haywire; reinput the destination and it recalibrates immediately
- **The List of Hate** — a practical tool for an extra push when motivation fails:
 - Open your notes app and title a note "List of Hate"
 - Write down everyone who wronged you, crossed you, hated on you, or said you couldn't accomplish your goals
 - **Pin that note to the top of your notes app**
 - When you feel like skipping the gym, cheating on your diet, or slacking on your business — open the list
 - Ask: "How happy would they be if I failed today? How happy would they be if I ate this cake?"
 - "They'd be thrilled and ecstatic. You can't let the haters win."
 - If you don't accomplish your goals — "That wasn't hating on you. That was a fair assessment of your current capabilities."
- Preemptive pushback: "Some guy will say you should do it for yourself." Brandon's response: if that's working for you, great — this tool is for people who sometimes need an extra kick
- The deeper insight: **transmuting hate into positive energy**
 - More hate is coming — that's guaranteed
 - When you harness it and use it as fuel: "You're invincible"
 - Analogy: judo — a small woman can flip a 200-lb man by using his own momentum against him

Habit 3: No Days Off — Never Quit 58:21

- Reframe: when you take a "day off," you didn't rest — **you quit briefly**
 - Starting over is the hardest part; by taking days off you force yourself to do the hardest part repeatedly
- **Rocket ship analogy:**
 - A rocket's fuel tanks are bigger than the ship because escaping the atmosphere requires massive energy
 - Once in space, it can coast — but if it stops and has to restart, it must escape gravity again
 - Even one day off = the rocket returning home and having to re-launch
- Clarification on "no days off" for fitness:
 - Not saying lift weights or run every single day — let muscles rest
 - On off days: stick to your diet 100%, get **10,000–20,000 steps**
 - Examples: walks with girlfriend, scooter rides with son around the neighborhood, laser tag or trampolines with nieces/nephews
- Why most people quit their fitness journeys:
 - **90% of cases:** took time off for a vacation, destination wedding, or business trip → let themselves slack → never restarted
 - "Starting is the hardest part. You keep doing the most difficult part over and over again."

- Root cause of inconsistency: **you accept inconsistency**
 - Common trap: "I ate clean all week, so I can have this cake/pizza/cookie"
- Brandon has had **zero cheat days in 3 years** — here's why:
 - After a cheat, returning to normal food feels worse because of contrast (like putting your hand from hot water to cold — it feels colder than it really is)
 - Cheat days induce cravings for the junk food you just ate, requiring *more* discipline to get back on track
 - "I used to do whole cheat days. The days after, I'd have cravings. It took more discipline to stick to my diet."
 - Once he stopped cheat days: cravings faded away over time

"Abstinence is easier than moderation."

- Same principle applied to alcohol: Brandon has been **sober for 11 years** — zero desire to drink because he's abstained so long
 - If he drank occasionally, he'd be constantly fighting cravings
- On recreational drugs: same — zero cravings after years of abstinence
- "All things in moderation" — Brandon's reframe:
 - "Those are the battle cries of the inconsistent"
 - "When someone says that to you, you are listening to a person justify their repeated failure for years if not decades"
- Key insight: discipline is finite; don't waste it by constantly inducing cravings you then have to fight



Habit 5: Use Family as Motivation, Not an Excuse [1:07:12](#) ---

- Common complaint Brandon hears from men in their mid-30s to 40s: "I used to be in great shape, but then I had kids and family..."
 - Brandon's response: "I hope your children never hear about you using them as an excuse for your own failure. That is despicable."
 - "It's not your kids' fault you have poor time management skills. Those kids didn't ask to be here. You chose to have them."
- **Story:** A friend complained his high-school-aged son was going down the wrong path and wouldn't listen to him
 - Brandon's blunt assessment: "Of course you can't get through to him. Look at you. You fat, you broke. You don't live a life that's aspirational to him."
 - "Why would anybody with half a brain take advice from somebody whose life they wouldn't want to live?"
- The right mindset: ask yourself — **"What kind of man do I have to be so I am influential in my son's life when he gets older?"**

- Don't settle for *obligatory* influence (he has to listen because he lives under your roof)
- Aim for *aspirational* influence — he *wants* to be like you
- If you're not his role model, he'll find one — could be a rapper, a drug dealer, or a toxic streamer
- "If you are in amazing shape, if you take care of all your responsibilities, if you're living your dreams... you can be not just his dad, but his hero."
- Brandon's age: **43**

⚙️ **Habit 6: Discipline Is for Amateurs — Use Friction Instead 1:13:21**

- Definition of discipline: doing what you're supposed to do, when you're supposed to do it, whether you feel like it or not — useful, but should be reserved for when it's truly needed
- Core concept: **friction management**
 - Increase friction for things you want to abstain from
 - Decrease friction for things you want to do more of
- **Example — Ice cream (abstinence):**
 - Brandon hasn't had ice cream in ~11 years despite it being one of his favorite foods
 - Secret: there is simply **no ice cream in his house**
 - If it were in the freezer, he'd see it every time he got ice — constant temptation requiring constant discipline
 - Could order via Instacart, but that extra friction (waiting, ordering) is enough to deter him
 - "I don't want to use a heroic amount of discipline all the time. I want to save it for when it's important."
- **The discipline battery** (from the book *Willpower*):
 - Discipline/willpower is like a battery — starts full after sleep, depletes as you use it throughout the day
 - Goal: don't drain it unnecessarily; have a full battery when you actually need it
- **Example — Morning workout (doing more of):**
 - Alarm is on the **other side of the large bedroom** — forces him to physically get up
 - Robe is right by the alarm; slippers are right there — puts them on immediately
 - Workout clothes are **already laid out the night before**
 - Pre-workout drink is **already mixed and waiting** the night before
 - Result: no decision-making, no friction — he's dressed and fueled in minutes
 - Contrast: if the phone were next to the bed, he'd just hit snooze
- **Example — Content creation:**
 - Camera and lights are **permanently set up** in his filming spot
 - All he has to do is sit down and hit record
 - Did this even when he was broke 15 years ago — kept a camera permanently ready
- **Action steps for today:**
 - List habits you want to develop that you've been slacking on → find ways to **decrease friction** for those

- List things you want to abstain from → find ways to **increase friction** for those

Habit 7: Get a Coach 1:19:16

- "Anything you're serious about, you need to get a coach."
- **Personal story — Guitar:**
 - First 3 months: self-taught via YouTube videos and books — made decent progress
 - Met a Nashville session musician who had just moved to New York and was starting guitar lessons
 - Brandon became his first student, **one session per week**
 - After just **1 month with the coach**, Brandon improved more than in the previous 3 months combined
 - Discovered he had been doing some things completely wrong — "It's difficult to see the picture when you're inside the frame"
 - Coach also gave weekly assignments; when Brandon didn't practice one week, the coach sent him home and **still charged him**
 - "It only took that one time. I felt shitty."
- Two core benefits of coaching:
 - **Faster learning:** a good coach corrects errors you can't see yourself; shortens the learning curve
 - **Accountability:** knowing someone is watching makes consistency require far less discipline
- **Accountability analogy:** Would you skip the gym if your gym partner was waiting for you? Probably not. That's coaching.
- **New Orleans Saints example:**
 - Won the Super Bowl one year with the same core team
 - The following year, coach was suspended — same players, same quarterback
 - Result: **didn't make the playoffs**
 - "These are NFL players performing at the highest level, and they went from champions to missing the playoffs without a coach."
- **Michael Jordan example:**
 - Jordan didn't win championships until he hired **Tim Grover** as his trainer/coach
 - Result: 6 championships, multiple MVPs
- Brandon's own practice: still hires coaches even after spending hundreds of thousands on mentorships
 - Has hired people who made **less** money than him just for accountability
 - "Every new level I get, I get coaches."
- Coaches make consistency easier by adding accountability friction — same principle as Habit 6

Final Super Chats & Wrap-Up 1:26:50

- **Super chat from Alex:** References Tony Robbins — "Our life is the sum of our decisions." Brandon responds: "Yeah, thought repellent coming soon" (upcoming product, ~2 weeks out pending enough super

chat revenue)

- **Super chat from Stephen:** "How long can you sustain 10–11 PM bedtime and 2 AM wake-up?"
 - Brandon: probably 2–3 days before hallucinations and mental issues set in
 - Solution: time management — 168 hours/week; 56 hours of sleep (8 hrs/night); 40 hours of work = still **72 hours left over**
 - "You ain't planning right."
- **Super chat follow-up from Stephen:** "If you've already spent tens of thousands on mentorships and have enough info, do you still need a coach?"
 - Brandon: yes — he still hires coaches despite spending hundreds of thousands
 - Key question: "Have you gotten where you want to go yet?"
 - Coaches provide accountability even if they earn less than you — it's not just about information
- **Wrap-up:** Victory Talk Podcast airs every **Tuesday and Thursday at 5:30 PM Eastern**